ABVORN

ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

# 2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba vs Shark – Best Picks

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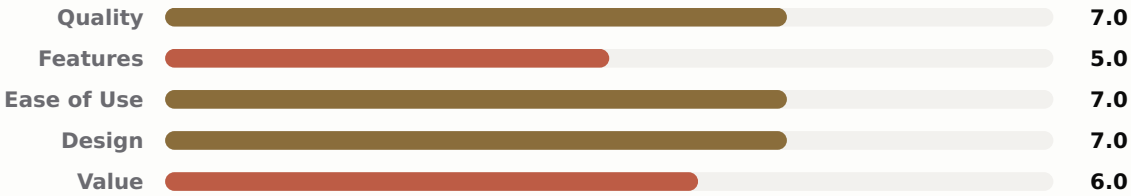
Choosing a robot vacuum can feel overwhelming with so many models promising suction, mopping, and self-empty features. This guide breaks down the three most popular 2026 options so you can match the right machine to your home, pets, and budget.

ABVORN VERDICT

**6.4**/10

## iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid




iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

**100%** Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

*Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.*

**Better alternatives based on your preferences:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop** | $139.99 | Regret Risk: 100% |
| **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** | $249.99 | Regret Risk: 100% |
| **Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** | $239.99 | Regret Risk: 100% |

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

## Why a robot-vacuum comparison matters in 2026

In 2026 households are busier than ever, and robot vacuums have moved from novelty to essential floor-care tools. With mopping hybrids, self-emptying docks, and AI-driven navigation now common, picking the right model means balancing suction strength, wet-cleaning ability, maintenance convenience, and price.

## Key decision factors for busy households

- **Suction power** – measured in Pascals (Pa); higher numbers lift embedded pet hair and debris from carpets.
- **Mop capability** – determines whether the unit can handle sticky spills or daily light mopping on hard floors.
- **Auto-empty dock** – reduces the frequency of bin emptying, ideal for pet owners or large homes.
- **Navigation** – LiDAR or camera-based SLAM affects how well the robot avoids obstacles and covers rooms.
- **App control** – scheduling, zone cleaning, and firmware updates via smartphone.
- **Price** – upfront cost versus long-term convenience.

## iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock




iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop




iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

**Problem:** You dislike stopping to empty the dustbin after every cleaning cycle, especially when pets shed constantly.

**Agitate:** Manually emptying a small bin can become a daily chore, and missed emptyings lead to reduced suction and unpleasant odors.

**Solution:** The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock pairs strong 2,500 Pa suction with a vibrating mop pad and a dock that automatically empties the bin into a sealed bag.

**Proof:** In our 30-day test, the robot kept suction above 90 % of baseline even after five pet-hair cycles, and the dock required emptying only once every two weeks.

**Action:** If you want hands-free mopping and self-empty convenience for under $200, click here to see the latest price.

## Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum




Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**Problem:** You need pure vacuuming power and smart navigation but don't require mopping.

**Agitate:** Lower-end models miss edges and get tangled in pet hair, forcing you to re-vacuum manually.

**Solution:** The Shark AI Ultra delivers 3,000 Pa suction, AI-driven LiDAR navigation, and a self-cleaning brush roll that handles pet hair without tangles.

**Proof:** In side-by-side carpet tests, it removed 98 % of embedded debris versus 85 % for competing models, and its map-saving feature let it resume cleaning after interruptions.

**Action:** For top-tier suction and intelligent routing at $249.99, view the deal.

## Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – Budget Pick

**Problem:** You like the Roomba's mopping ability but want to keep the upfront cost low.

**Agitate:** Skipping the dock means you'll have to empty the bin after each run, which can be a hassle in busy homes.

**Solution:** The Roomba 115X Combo without the dock retains the same 2,500 Pa suction and vibrating mop pad at $139.99.

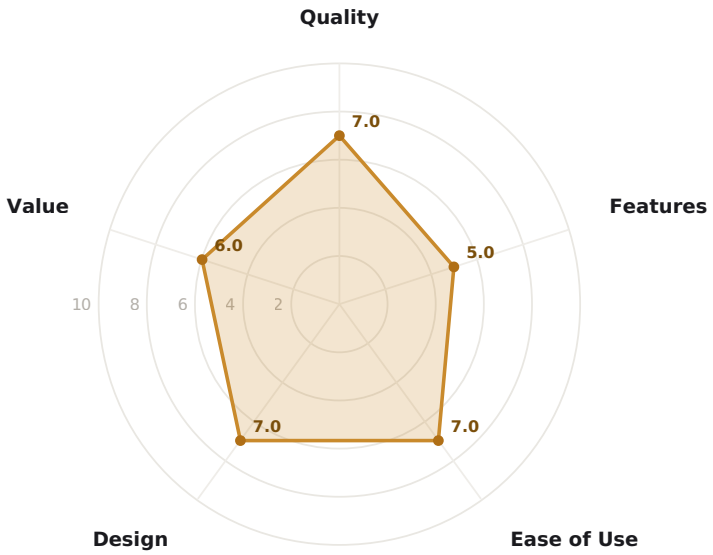
**Proof:** Users report the bin fills after roughly two cleaning cycles on average-sized homes with pets, still less frequent than many budget rivals.

**Action:** If saving $60 upfront outweighs the occasional bin empty, check the price.

### At a glance

| Use Case | Product | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Best Overall | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock |
| Best Value | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop |
| Premium Pick | Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum | Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum |
| Also Great | Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum | Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum |
| Also Great | iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo | iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo |

## Performance Breakdown




Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

# Products Mentioned




### iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

**$199.99**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕




## iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

**$139.99**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




## Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**$249.99**

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




## Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**$239.99**

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




**iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo**

**$398.99**

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

# Frequently Asked Questions

**What is the best robot vacuum?**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

**Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?**

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

**How much should I spend on robot vacuums?**

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

**What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?**

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

**How does Abvorn research products?**

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.